

Effective from: 3 June 2026

Valid until: Further notice

Applies to: All staff travelling for World Vision (WV) business purposes.

This advisory provides context, health guidance, and operational advice in response to the escalating Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) and Uganda.

TRAVEL STANCE

Defer ALL non-essential travel to: DRC and Uganda.

Essential travel may proceed with enhanced precautions following approval from the National Director (ND) in consultation with the Regional Security Director (RSD). Staff should anticipate disruption and maintain contingency options.

Suspend ALL travel to: Ituri Province, North Kivu, South Kivu, and all officially designated outbreak zones.

Mission-critical travel requires approval from the DRC National Director (ND) or Regional Leader (RL) in consultation with the RSD.

Travel may proceed to: Rwanda and South Sudan with enhanced precautions.

Travel requires enhanced precautions following review of routing and contingency planning. Staff should anticipate additional screening, entry requirements, and potential travel disruption.

In-country personnel:

Defer ALL non-essential movement to outbreak-affected areas. Operational and response-related travel should only proceed where necessary, approved, and conducted in line with public health directives and WV security guidance.

ADVICE

- **Travel necessity:** All planned travel to DRC and Uganda should be critically reviewed and only proceed where operationally essential and appropriately approved.
- **Returning Travellers:** Staff returning from DRC, Uganda, Rwanda, South Sudan, or outbreak-affected areas should carefully consider the impact on subsequent travel plans. Several governments have introduced enhanced screening, quarantine requirements, routing restrictions, or entry limitations for travellers arriving from affected countries. Staff should verify all destination and transit-country requirements before travel and anticipate additional screening, delays, or movement restrictions following travel.
- **Health precautions:** Avoid close contact with individuals displaying symptoms of illness and avoid contact with bodily fluids, contaminated materials, or human remains. Practice good hand hygiene through regular handwashing and use of alcohol-based hand sanitiser. Avoid consumption of bushmeat.
- **Traveller guidance:** Staff should seek medical advice immediately if symptoms develop during or following travel. Staff returning from outbreak-affected areas should self-monitor for symptoms for 21 days following departure from affected locations.
- **Flight & border disruption:** Enhanced health screening, quarantine requirements, border closures, and short-notice travel disruption remain possible across the region. Several governments, including the US, Canada, Jordan, Rwanda, and Uganda, have introduced additional screening, quarantine, border, or entry restrictions impacting travellers from outbreak-affected countries. Additional measures may be introduced by other governments with limited notice. Staff should confirm routing viability, transit requirements, and destination entry conditions prior to departure.
- **Management responsibilities:** Leaders and managers should review upcoming travel plans and defer non-essential travel to affected areas where operationally feasible. Ensure travellers understand any potential onward travel restrictions, quarantine requirements, and return-travel implications before booking travel.

- **Monitoring & escalation:** Monitor all updates issued by Security, Safety & Resilience, World Health Organization (WHO), local authorities, and WV security teams. Notify your manager or security focal point immediately if assistance is required.

SYMPTOMS AND TRANSMISSION

Bundibugyo virus disease (BVD) is a form of Ebola disease transmitted through direct contact with bodily fluids, contaminated materials, infected individuals, or infected animals. Ebola is not spread through casual or airborne contact. There is currently no approved vaccine or targeted treatment available for the Bundibugyo strain of Ebola virus, making early detection, symptom monitoring, and infection prevention measures particularly important. Symptoms may appear between two and 21 days following exposure and can include:

- Fever
- Fatigue and weakness
- Headache and muscle pain
- Vomiting and diarrhoea
- Abdominal pain
- Unexplained bleeding or bruising in severe cases

Staff experiencing symptoms or requiring medical advice or assistance while travelling internationally should contact the [24/7 AIG emergency assistance hotline](#) for confidential support and referral guidance.

CONTEXT

On 17 May 2026, the World Health Organization (WHO) declared the current Bundibugyo virus disease (BVD) outbreak affecting the DRC and Uganda a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC).

The outbreak remains concentrated in eastern DRC, particularly Ituri, North Kivu, and South Kivu provinces, with confirmed linked cases identified in Uganda. The outbreak is considered a high-risk regional public health event due to delayed outbreak detection, ongoing insecurity, population displacement, and the absence of an approved vaccine or targeted treatment for the Bundibugyo strain.

While widespread international transmission remains unlikely, the risk of further regional spread remains elevated. Regional monitoring and preparedness measures have increased across neighbouring countries, particularly South Sudan, Rwanda, and Burundi. Several governments have also introduced enhanced screening, quarantine, border, and entry requirements for travellers arriving from affected countries, contributing to increasing travel restrictions and operational disruption across the region.

WHO, regional governments, and international partners continue to scale up response measures across affected areas. WVI Health is participating in the Global Health Cluster working group to monitor the outbreak alongside ongoing internal health, security, and operational coordination efforts.

World Vision continues to monitor the situation closely in consultation with public health authorities, medical risk providers, and travel risk partners.

RESOURCES

- [World Health Organization \(WHO\)](#)
- [US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention \(CDC\)](#)
- [WV Travel Resources \(wvcentral\)](#)
- [WV Ebola Category 3 Response \(wvcentral\)](#)

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